

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

2. Requirement Analysis

2.1 Business Requirements

The system should support the following business requirements:

Requirement	Description
Incident Creation	Service Desk agents should be able to create incidents.
Classification	Incidents should contain appropriate category, subcategory, urgency, service, and CI information.
Knowledge Integration	Agents should be able to search and attach relevant Knowledge Articles.
Assignment	Incidents should be assigned to appropriate support groups.
Escalation	Level 2 teams should be able to investigate and resolve incidents.
Change Integration	Emergency changes should be associated with incidents.
Child Incidents	Related or recurring issues should be tracked through child incidents.
Resolution	Cause, resolution code, and resolution notes should be documented.
Knowledge Creation	Resolved incidents should be converted into Knowledge Articles where appropriate.
SLA Tracking	SLA information should be visible throughout the incident lifecycle.

2.2 Functional Requirements

FR-01: Service Creation

The system should support creation of a service:

- **Service:** Remote Access
- **Operational Status:** Operational

FR-02: Service Offering Creation

A service offering should be created under the Remote Access service:

- **Service Offering:** Corporate VPN
- **Parent Service:** Remote Access
- **Operational Status:** Operational

FR-03: Incident Creation

The Service Desk agent should be able to create an incident with:

- Short Description
- Caller
- Assignment Group

- Description
- Channel
- Category
- Subcategory
- Urgency
- Service
- Service Offering
- Configuration Item

FR-04: Incident Classification

The incident should be classified appropriately.

Example:

- **Category:** Network
- **Subcategory:** VPN
- **Urgency:** 2 – Medium
- **Service:** Remote Access
- **Service Offering:** Corporate VPN
- **Configuration Item:** ThinkStationS20

FR-05: Knowledge Integration

Agent Assist should recommend relevant Knowledge Articles based on the incident description.

The agent should be able to:

- View recommended articles.
- Open an article.
- Mark an article as Helpful.
- Attach the article to the incident.
- Add comments regarding the article.

FR-06: Watch List and Work Notes

The system should allow users to be added to:

- Watch List
- Work Notes List

This allows stakeholders to monitor incident progress and updates.

FR-07: Reassignment

The incident should be reassigned from the Service Desk to the appropriate Level 2 support group.

Example:

Service Desk → Network

FR-08: Investigation

The Level 2 Network team should be able to:

- View incident details.
- View Knowledge Articles.
- Review activity.
- View SLA information.
- Take ownership of the incident.

FR-09: Change Integration

When a change is required to resolve the incident, the incident should support creation and tracking of an emergency change request.

The incident can be placed in:

On Hold → Awaiting Change

FR-10: Child Incident

The system should allow creation of child incidents for recurring or related issues.

The child incident should be linked to the parent incident.

FR-11: Cause Documentation

The probable cause of the incident should be documented.

Example:

PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart.

FR-12: Resolution Documentation

The system should record:

- Resolution Code
- Resolution Notes

Example:

- **Resolution Code:** Workaround provided
- **Resolution Notes:** Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.

FR-13: Knowledge Article Creation

After resolving the incident, the solution should be reusable by creating a Knowledge Article.

Requirements:

- Knowledge Base: IT
- Template: Standard
- Article should contain relevant incident resolution information.

FR-14: SLA Tracking

The system should provide visibility into applicable SLAs through the incident's related records.